ASSETS · AI

Your first token

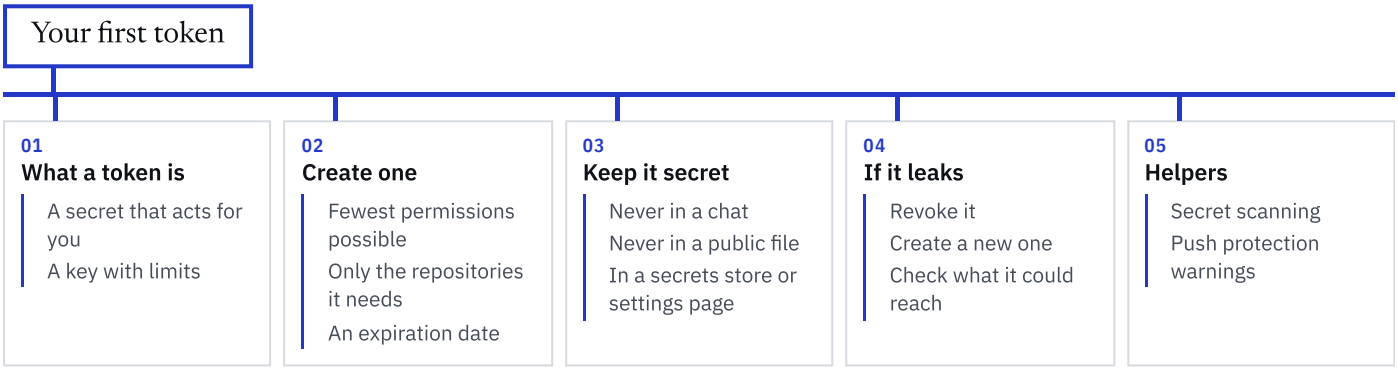
What a token is, why it matters, and how to keep it secret.

PLANNED

What you will learn

An access token is a long secret string that lets a program act on your behalf, the way a key opens a door. Websites and AI tools ask for one when your code needs to read data or publish something. This piece shows what a token is, how to create one with the fewest permissions that will do the job, where to keep it so it never lands in a chat or a public file, and what to do if it leaks: revoke it at once and create a new one with an expiration date. Small habits, and they protect everything else you build.

Map of the piece



Sources

1 **Managing your personal access tokens**
GitHub, 2026
docs.github.com

2 **Secret scanning**
GitHub, 2026
docs.github.com

3 **Secrets Management Cheat Sheet**
OWASP Foundation, 2026
cheatsheetseries.owasp.org

Each source was opened and checked on 14 October 2026. The finished piece may add more.